DESTINATION

HOTEL

LONDON'S LATEST LANDMARK

The British capital's newest destination for art, design, and elevated hospitality: The Chancery Rosewood.

Rashmi Uday Singh

The rave reviews about London's latest landmark hotel kickstart my curiosity, not only because I love to live in hotels, write about them but also study them in great detail. For me, the hotel I stay in makes or breaks my experience of the city. The tsunami of publicity around the opening of The Chancery Rosewood, London has me licking my chops, sharpening my taste buds and charging up my camera as I fly in to London.

Full disclosure: I am a full-time Rosewood hotel group fan, and have known the high octane Radha Arora, the president of the award winning global group, for the past twenty years since his stint at the Four seasons Beverly Wilshire, Los Angeles. Though I've paid for all my Rosewood hotel stays, around the world, including the recent one at the Rosewood Hongkong (when I attended Asia's 50 Best restaurant awards), I was invited for three complimentary nights to London's Chancery Rosewood. I stayed an extra night (and paid GBP 1,900 (Rs 2,41,000); it's the discounted rate for the extra night), and ensured that I paid fully for five of my restaurant meals, after inviting many a guest to each. Just to make sure that I erred on the side of objectivity, I patiently checked out the hotel, from the top (literally, at the roof- top Eagle bar with the Maharaja of Udaipur, Dr Lakshyaraj Singh Mewar) to the three restaurants on the ground floor. Did it live up to it's reviews? Is there hope behind the hype?



Photograph: CHANTAL ARNTS



Photograph: BEN ANDERS